CP7 Checklist

Project / repo _____

Every stranger who meets a project — a potential contributor, a user, an employer — meets it through the same few files, in the same order: **What is this? Can I run it? May I use it? How do I help? What's it like here?** Check each item the way that stranger would, not the way you would. You already know everything, and they don't.

1 · README `README.md`

- [ ] The **first sentence** says what it is and who it's for
- [ ] A **status** line: what works today
- [ ] A **quickstart** that works from a fresh clone
- [ ] Links to CONTRIBUTING; ends with a license line

2 · License `LICENSE`

- [ ] Exact license text, with year and holder filled in
- [ ] A **one-paragraph rationale** recorded: why *this* license for *this* project, not MIT by reflex

3 · Contributing guide `CONTRIBUTING.md`

- [ ] Opens with **how to get started**, not with rules
- [ ] Setup, how to pick work, the PR process, review expectations (grown from your git standards)
- [ ] Says what a newcomer should do **first**

4 · Code of conduct `CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md`

- [ ] **Adopted** from a standard (Contributor Covenant), not written from scratch
- [ ] Reporting contact and enforcement filled in for your project

5 · Templates + labels `.github/`

- [ ] **Bug template** asks for steps to reproduce, expected vs. actual, and environment
- [ ] **Feature template** asks for the need, the user, and today's workaround
- [ ] **PR template** checklist pulled from your git standards
- [ ] Labels: `bug`, `enhancement`, `good first issue`, plus your own

6 · Setup guide — cold-tested `docs/`

The author's machine hides state — the env var you set months ago, the tool you forgot you installed. Only a cold reader finds it.

- [ ] Someone who **didn't write it** followed it exactly, from a fresh clone
- [ ] Each failure or confusion filed as an issue
- [ ] Guide fixed and issues closed. The closed issues stay visible; they're your evidence.

7 · Communication norms `docs/communication-norms.md`

- [ ] Where discussion happens
- [ ] Response times you can **actually keep** ("within a week," not "24/7")
- [ ] Who maintains, and how decisions get made

8 · Seed issues `Issues tab`

- [ ] 2–3 real next-work items, filed **through your own templates**

✓ · Ship it `Canvas`

- [ ] Everything merged to `main` through reviewed PRs
- [ ] Repo pointer (tag or commit hash) submitted in Canvas

> **Where the points are:** the two heaviest criteria are **Completeness** (everything above, substantive) and **Newcomer usability** (a stranger installs, runs, and starts contributing from the docs alone), worth 25 each. The same stranger's test comes back in the repo audit.

Punch list for the build workshop — *what's missing or weak in your repo today, in the order you'll fix it*